Bentley Oakes

Assistant Professor

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Key Academic Skills

Researcher: Lead- and co-author of dozens of publications with hundreds of citations on Google Scholar.

Collaborator: Involved in multiple international academic and industrial collaborations.

Teacher/Mentor: Extensive experience teaching courses and mentoring graduate students.

Community-Builder: Organizing and program committee member for local and global events.

Language Skills

English: Native proficiency

French: Intermediate

Education

PhD **McGill University**, Computer Science — Montréal, Canada, 2019
- Thesis: *A Symbolic Execution-Based Approach To Model Transformation Verification using Structural Contracts*
- Supervisors: Hans Vangheluwe and Clark Verbrugge

MSc **McGill University**, Computer Science — Montréal, Canada, 2013
- Thesis: *Practical and Theoretical Issues of Evolving Behaviour Trees for a Turn-Based Game*
- Supervisor: Clark Verbrugge

BSc **University of Manitoba**, Computer Science (Honours) — Winnipeg, Canada, 2011
- Co-op internship at Electronic Arts Inc., Montréal — Fall 2009, Summer 2010: Prototyping artificial intelligence in commercial video games.
- Co-op internship at Blackberry Limited (RIM), Waterloo — Winter 2009: Implementing cryptographic communication protocols.

Research Experience

Polytechnique Montréal, Assistant Professor — Montréal, Canada, Sep. 2023 – present
- Department of Computer and Software Engineering (GIGL)
- Research topics: Accelerating the construction and deployment of digital twins through ontologies for capturing domain knowledge, and large language models and agentic AI for automating their creation. Integrating formal methods to verify digital twin correctness, and assisting users with the configuration and observability of their machine learning and verification/validation services.

Mila – Quebec AI Institute, Associate Academic Member — Montréal, Canada, Oct. 2026 – present

IVADO, Researcher — Montréal, Canada, Sep. 2025 – present

Université de Montréal, Post-Doctoral Researcher — Montréal, Canada
- Lab: GEODES Software Engineering Research Group — Sep. 2021 – Aug. 2023
- Supervisors: Houari Sahraoui and Michalis Famelis
- Research topic: Assisting non-machine learning experts in constructing ML solutions by exploring tailoring of computational workflows.
- Research topic: Extracting and structuring developer rationale from open-source commit messages using NLP and Large Language Models, in collaboration with PhD student Mouna Dhaouadi.

University of Antwerp, Post-Doctoral Researcher — Antwerp, Belgium
- Labs: Antwerp Systems and Software Modelling, and Constrained Systems Lab — Sep. 2018 – Jul. 2021
- Supervisors: Hans Vangheluwe and Joachim Denil
- Research topics: Verification and validation of cyber-physical systems, model-driven engineering, multi-paradigm modelling, co-simulation, and digital twins.

Université de Montréal, Visiting Researcher — Montréal, Canada
- Host: Eugene Syriani, GEODES Software Engineering Research Group — May 2018
- Research topic: Developing an interface between the AToMPM modelling tool and the ModelVerse modelling repository.

fortiss GmbH, Visiting Researcher — Munich, Germany
- Host: Levi Lúcio — Jul. – Aug. 2016
- Research topic: Formalizing representations of model transformation languages.

General Motors Technical Center, Visiting Researcher — Warren, USA
- Host: Ramesh Sethu — Oct. – Dec. 2014
- Research topics: Applying model transformations for code/model modernization at an industrial scale, and industrial intellectual property concerns.

Industrial Collaborations

Framework for Systematic Design of Digital Twins (DTDesign) — 2019–2021
- Collaborators: Atlas Copco, Flanders Make
- Topics: Digital twin characteristics, integrating knowledge graphs and digital twins.
- Funding: Flanders Innovation and Entrepreneurship Agency (VLAIO)

Automated & Simulation-based Functional Safety Engineering Methodology (aSET) — 2018–2020
- Collaborators: Dana Belgium NV, Siemens Industry Software (Leuven), Flanders Make
- Topics: Verification of safety-critical cyber-physical systems (formal methods, reinforcement learning-based fault injection for hazard discovery, simulation/visualization), DevOps for functional safety.
- Funding: Flanders Innovation and Entrepreneurship Agency (VLAIO)

Innovation in the Development of Electrical Systems For Aeronautics (INES) — 2019–2020
- Collaborators: Boeing Research & Technology Europe (Madrid), Siemens Industry Software (Leuven), Flanders Make
- Topics: Co-simulation configuration, fault injection in co-simulation.
- Funding: Flanders Innovation and Entrepreneurship Agency (VLAIO)

Network for the Engineering of Complex Software-Intensive Systems for Automotive Systems (NECSIS) — 2013–2016
- Collaborators: General Motors of Canada Ltd., Queen's University, University of Antwerp
- Topic: Verification of model transformations.
- Funding: $14M from Automotive Partnership Canada and Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC)

Teaching Experience

Polytechnique Montréal, Course Instructor — Montréal, Canada — 2024 – present
- Engineering of Digital Twins (LOG8421E) — Winter 2025, Winter 2026
- Introduction à la programmation (INF1007) — Fall 2025, Fall 2026
- Software Quality Engineering (LOG8371E) — Fall 2024
- Scientific and Technical Communication (INF6900AE/INF7900A) — Winter 2024, Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Fall 2026

Polytechnique Montréal, Guest Lecturer — Montréal, Canada — 2022 – 2024
- XR Software Development (LOG8704) — Nov. 2024: *Digital Twins: Introductions and Intersections*
- Model-Driven Software Engineering (LOG6953DE) — Nov. 2022, Nov. 2023: Model-driven engineering, usage and verification of model transformations

McGill University, Course Lecturer/Coordinator — Montréal, Canada — 2015 – 2018
- Foundations of Programming (COMP 202) — Winter 2015, 2017, 2018 (avg. 189 students)
- Developed and presented lecture material on Java programming for students with no prior programming experience.
- Created assessments and marking guides; coordinated with other instructors and TAs.

University of Antwerp, Teaching Assistant — Antwerp, Belgium — 2019 – 2020
- Model-Driven Engineering (2001WETMTR) — Fall 2020
- Modelling of Software-Intensive Systems (2001WETMSI) — Fall 2019

McGill University, Teaching Assistant — Montréal, Canada — 2012 – 2014
- Foundations of Programming (COMP 202, ×2)
- Introduction to Computer Science (COMP 250, ×2)
- Data Structures and Algorithms (COMP 251, ×3)

Student Supervision

Kérian Fiter — PhD Student — 2024–present
- Digital twin federation, trust, and observability
- Ontological federation and reasoning, large language models, and time-series foundation models

Carlos Pambo — PhD Student — 2024–present
- Recommendations and patterns for digital twin engineering
- Ontologies for digital twin engineering

Adil Lagrou — PhD Student — 2026–present
- Formalization of digital twin component interoperability
- Ontological federation and reasoning for interoperability

Gabrielle Gallant — Master's Student — 2025–present
- AI-enhanced digital twins for vibration analysis in manufacturing
- Machine learning techniques including time-series foundation models
- Co-supervised with Oguzhan Tuysuz

Angelica Portocarrero — Master's Student — 2026–present
- Structured digital twin engineering with LLMs
- Previously Mitacs Globalink Research Intern (2025)

Fatima Aguel — Mitacs Globalink Research Intern — Summer 2026
- Ontological modelling of digital twin component repositories

Mikkel Schmidt Andersen — Research Intern 2025
- Probabilistic digital twin update scheduling

Louis Malassigné-Onfroy — Research Assistant 2024
- Visualization of digital twin architectures

Amélie Bosphore — Research Assistant 2024
- Implementation of modelled machine learning pipelines

Justin Caisse — Research Assistant 2023–2024
- Ontological modelling of machine learning pipelines

Invited Talks and Presentations

Guest lecture — Engineering Digital Twins course, McMaster University Mar. 2026
- Host: Prof. Istvan David
- *What Does Your Digital Twin Do? A Framework and Tooling for Systematic DT Reporting*

Invited talk — SIG LLODIA (Lecture #3) Jan. 2026
- *Towards Ontology-based Digital Twin Service Construction and Reporting*

Guest lecture — RAISE course, UCLA Nov. 2025
- Host: Dr. Maged Elaasar
- *What is a 'Digital Twin' and How Do I Build One?*

Tutorial — Software Engineering for Machine Learning Applications (SEMLA) Jun. 2025
- *What is a 'Digital Twin' and How Do I Build One?*

Invited talk — EDT.Community May 2025
- *Systematic Digital Twin Reporting*
- Video recording

Invited talk — Next-Generation Cities Institute, Concordia University May 2025
- *Accelerating Digital Twin Research and Engineering*

Conference paper presentation — ICSE 2025, Ottawa May 2025
- *Building Domain-Specific Machine Learning Workflows: A Conceptual Framework for the State-of-the-Practice* (journal-first)

Guest lecture — Engineering Digital Twins course, McMaster University Mar. 2025
- Host: Prof. Istvan David
- *Accelerating Digital Twin Research and Engineering*

Research presentation — KARI Delegation, Polytechnique Montréal Feb. 2025
- Advanced Air Mobility (AAM) challenges and advancements

Invited talk — Software Engineering at Montréal (SEMTL) 2025
- *Recent Work on Systematic Reporting and Construction for Digital Twins*

Guest lecture — LOG8704 XR Software Development, Polytechnique Montréal Nov. 2024
- *Digital Twins: Introductions and Intersections*

Conference paper presentation — MODELS 2024 Sep. 2024
- *Fault localization in DSLTrans model transformations by combining symbolic execution and spectrum-based analysis* (SoSyM journal-first)

Invited talk — onto:Nexus Forum 2024 Jan. 2024
- *Accelerating Digital Twin Construction with Ontologies*
- 1st International Forum on Ontological Modeling and Analysis, NASA JPL (attended online)

Invited talk — Polytechnique Montréal 2023
- *Bridging the Gap in Verification and Validation of Complex Systems*

Guest lecture — LOG6953DE, Polytechnique Montréal Nov. 2022
- Host: Prof. Mohammad Hamdaqa
- *Model/Graph Transformations: Specification and Verification*

Invited talk — Software Engineering at Montréal (SEMTL) September seminar Sep. 2022
- *Building Domain-Specific Machine Learning Workflows: A Conceptual Framework for the State-of-the-Practice*

Invited talk — Concordia University 2022
- Host: Prof. Essam Mansour
- *Building Domain-Specific Machine Learning Workflows: A Conceptual Framework for the State-of-the-Practice*

Invited talk — Université du Québec à Montréal 2022
- *Capturing and Utilising Domain-Specific Knowledge*

Community Building

Workshop Organizer — onto:Nexus Workshop 2026 (International Workshop on Ontological Modeling and Analysis) 2026
- Co-located with MODELS 2026, Malaga, Spain.
- Co-organizers: Maged Elaasar (Chair), Wahab Hamou-Lhadj, Mohammad Hamdaqa, Eduard Kamburjan

Workshop Organizer — onto:Nexus Workshop 2025 (International Workshop on Ontological Modeling and Analysis) Oct. 2025
- Co-located with MODELS 2025, Grand Rapids, MI. Hybrid event with IEEE proceedings.
- Co-organizers: Maged Elaasar (Chair), Wahab Hamou-Lhadj, Mohammad Hamdaqa

Lead Organizer — Software Engineering at Montréal (SEMTL) Montréal, Canada
Aug. 2022 – present
- Regular seminars for the software engineering researchers in Montréal (~40 attendees per meeting, ~30% are professors).
- Coordinating with meeting hosts on content, venue, date, and maintaining website.

Organizing Committee Member 2022–2027
- MODELS — Publicity Co-Chair (2027), Student Volunteer Co-Chair (2025), Posters Co-Chair (2022)
- SEMLA — General Chair (2026), Posters Co-Chair (2024, 2025)
- FSE 2026 — Student Volunteer Co-Chair
- ICSE 2025 — Posters Co-Chair
- EDTconf 2024 — Publicity Co-Chair
- ANNSIM — Proceedings Co-Chair (2024), Cyber-Physical Systems Track Co-Chair (2022, 2023)

Program Committee Member 2019–2026

- ASE — Research Track (2026), NIER Track (2025)
- WSC — Simulation in Digital Twins Track — 2026
- MODELS — Artifact Evaluation Track (2026), Research Track (2025)
- EDTconf — 2024, 2025, 2026
- ANNSIM — 2021–2024, 2026
- DIGITA Workshop (PerCom) — 2026
- IDETWIN Workshop (CCNC) — 2026
- International Workshop on Architecting and Engineering Digital Twins (AEDT) — 2025, 2026
- International Workshop on Models and Evolution — 2022, 2026
- EMMSAD — 2025
- MDE Intelligence — 2022, 2023, 2024
- ACM Student Research Competition — 2022
- Spring/Summer Simulation Conference — 2019, 2020

Journal Reviewer 2020–2026

- Journal of Software and Systems Modeling (SoSyM) — 2020, 2021, 2023, 2025, 2026 (Top 1% Reviewer 2020, 2021; Best Reviewer Award 2025)
- KI – Künstliche Intelligenz — 2026
- Journal of Object Technology (JOT) — 2022, 2026
- Journal of Systems & Software (JSS) — 2025
- Information and Software Technology (IST) — 2025
- ACM Transactions on Software Engineering and Methodology (TOSEM) — 2024
- SIMULATION — 2023, 2024 (Best Reviewer Award June 2023)
- Science of Computer Programming (SCP) — 2023
- Journal of Computer Languages (JCL) — 2022
- Empirical Software Engineering (EMSE) — 2022
- IEEE Transactions on Automation Science and Engineering (T-ASE) — 2021

Guest Editor for Journal Special Issue 2023

- SIMULATION — *Modeling and Simulation for Software-Intensive Systems: from IoT to Digital Twins*

Jury Member 2023–2026

- Polytechnique Montréal — PhD Thesis Jury Member (2026)
- Polytechnique Montréal — M.Sc. Thesis Jury President ×4 (2024, 2026)
- Polytechnique Montréal — Examen de synthèse (doctoral qualifying exam) Jury ×3 (2025–2026)
- INSA Lyon / Polytechnique Montréal — PhD Thesis Jury Member (2026)
- McGill University — M.Sc. and PhD Thesis External Reviewer (2023–2024)

Grant Reviewer 2024–2026

- NSERC Idea to Innovation grant — 2024
- NSERC Discovery grant — 2025, 2026
- Dutch Research Council (NWO) — 2026

Panelist 2023

- ANNSIM PhD Colloquium Panel — 2023

Departmental Service 2024–Present

- Committee Member, Committee Rayonnement (Communications committee), Department of Computer and Software Engineering, Polytechnique Montréal

Scholarships and Awards

SoSyM Best Reviewer Award 2025
- Journal of Software & Systems Modeling

Simulation Journal Best Reviewer Award June 2023

SoSyM Top 1% Reviewer 2020, 2021
- Journal of Software & Systems Modeling

Best Student Paper Award 2019
- SIMULTECH — for the paper *HintCO – Hint-based configuration of co-simulations*

NSERC Postgraduate Scholarship – Doctoral (PGS D) 2015–2016
- Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada

Lorne Trottier Science Accelerator Fellowship 2015, 2016
- McGill University

Harold H. Helm Fellowship 2013, 2014
- McGill University

Grad Excellence Award in Computer Science 2012, 2014
- McGill University

Selected Publications

Bridging the Semantic Web and Model-Based Systems Engineering with the Ontological Modeling Language Oct. 2026
Maged Elaasar, **Bentley Oakes**, Eduard Kamburjan, Mohammad Hamdaqa, Abdelwahab Hamou-Lhadj
(International Semantic Web Conference (ISWC) — accepted)

Involving before Evolving: A Vision for Trustworthy Enterprise Digital Twin Engineering Oct. 2026
Kérian Fiter, Adil Lagrou, **Bentley Oakes**, Franck Dervault
10.1145/3837062.3839094 (MODELS Companion (EDTconf))

Model-based digital twin engineering: insights, challenges, and future directions May 2026
Philipp Zech, Souvik Barat, Benjamin Nast, **Bentley Oakes**, Judith Michael, Steffen Zschaler, Balbir Barn, Ruth Breu
10.1007/s10270-026-01368-8 (Software and Systems Modeling (SoSyM))

Automated Extraction and Analysis of Developer's Rationale in Open Source Software 2025
Mouna Dhaouadi, **Bentley Oakes**, Michalis Famelis
10.1145/3729383 (Proceedings of the ACM on Software Engineering (FSE))

DTInsight: A Tool for Explicit, Interactive, and Continuous Digital Twin Reporting 2025
Kérian Fiter, Louis Malassigné-Onfroy, **Bentley Oakes**
10.1109/MODELS-C68889.2025.00030 (MODELS Companion (MODELS-C))

Building Domain-Specific Machine Learning Workflows: A Conceptual Framework for the State of the Practice Apr. 2024
Bentley Oakes, Michalis Famelis, Houari Sahraoui
10.1145/3638243 (ACM Transactions on Software Engineering and Methodology (TOSEM))

Toward Intelligent Generation of Tailored Graphical Concrete Syntax 2024
Meriem Ben Chaaben, Oussama Ben Sghaier, Mouna Dhaouadi, Nafisa Elrasheed, Ikram Darif, Imen Jaoua, **Bentley Oakes**, Eugene Syriani, Mohammad Hamdaqa
10.1145/3640310.3674085 (MODELS 2024)

Towards Ontological Service-Driven Engineering of Digital Twins 2024
Bentley Oakes, Claudio Gomes, Eduard Kamburjan, Giuseppe Abbiati, Elif Ecem Bas, Sebastian Engelsgaard
10.1145/3652620.3688261 (MODELS Companion (EDTconf) — Best Short Paper Award)

Toward a Systematic Reporting Framework for Digital Twins: A Cooperative Robotics Case Study 2024
Santiago Gil, **Bentley Oakes**, Cláudio Gomes, Mirgita Frasheri, Peter G. Larsen
10.1177/00375497241261406 (SIMULATION)

openCAESAR: Balancing Agility and Rigor in Model-Based Systems Engineering 2023
Maged Elaasar, Nicolas Rouquette, David Wagner, **Bentley Oakes**, Abdelwahab Hamou-Lhadj, Mohammad Hamdaqa
10.1109/MODELS-C59198.2023.00051 (MODELS Companion (MODELS-C))

Machine Learning-Based Fault Injection for Hazard Analysis and Risk Assessment 2021
Bentley Oakes, Mehrdad Moradi, Simon Van Mierlo, Hans Vangheluwe, Joachim Denil
10.1007/978-3-030-83903-1_12 (SAFECOMP 2021 (Computer Safety, Reliability, and Security))

Publications

- See bentleyoakes.com/publications for a full list of dozens of peer-reviewed publications, including journal articles, book chapters, conference papers, workshop papers, and technical reports/theses.